

Project Report – Digital Literacy

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Introduction of the Project

As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador, my mission is to bridge the gap between my peers and the responsible, effective use of digital tools. This Digital Literacy Portfolio serves as both my capstone project for the selection process and a practical resource that will be shared with my batch. The project is structured around five core modules of digital literacy, each translated into a hands-on task that simulates real-world scenarios a student might encounter.

All work is housed in a single GitHub repository, demonstrating not only the technical skill of version control and documentation but also providing a centralized, accessible hub where peers can find guides, examples, and best practices. This written report accompanies the repository, offering a narrative of my process, challenges, and key takeaways.

The 5 Tasks & Scenarios :

Each task is rooted in a realistic scenario that a Student Digital Ambassador would face when helping fellow students navigate the digital world.

- Task 1 involves practicing coding on beginner-friendly platforms and documenting the work.
- Task 2 focuses on creating professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.
- Task 3 includes building a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms.
- Task 4 covers digital communication, email etiquette, cyber safety checklists, and case studies.
- Task 5 involves designing an infographic and online safety awareness material.

Overall, this project helps students develop technical awareness, professional communication skills, and responsible digital behaviour for academic and future career growth.

Task 1 – Presentation Report

Tool Used

I used Canva to create the infographic, chosen for its user-friendly interface and extensive library of free templates and icons.

Design Overview

The infographic, titled "The Digital Student's Toolkit," covers three key topics in a clean vertical layout. The first section defines digital literacy as the ability to find, evaluate, and communicate using digital tools responsibly. The second section highlights useful tools like Google Workspace for collaboration, Notion for organization, and Canva for design. The third section presents safe internet practices through a simple checklist: use strong passwords, enable two-factor authentication, and verify URLs to avoid phishing. A consistent navy and teal color scheme with icons ensures the content is visually scannable and professional.

Challenge

The most difficult aspect was condensing complex information into limited space without losing clarity. I learned that effective infographics rely on visual hierarchy using headings, icons, and short bullet points to communicate key messages efficiently.

Task 2 – Portfolio Report

Platforms Chosen

I created and updated accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle three platforms that serve distinct yet complementary purposes in my professional development.

Purpose of Each Platform

GitHub serves as my technical portfolio, hosting code projects and documentation. I created a profile README repository named after my username, which now displays my name, branch, year, and my learning goal: "I hope to build real-world projects that solve campus challenges while mastering collaborative development workflows."

LinkedIn is my professional networking hub. I completed my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year, establishing a credible presence for recruiters and peers.

Kaggle functions as my data science learning playground. It offers datasets, notebooks, and competitions to develop analytical skills through hands-on practice.

Future Plans

Over the next four years, I will use GitHub to document all major projects and contribute to open-source. LinkedIn will help me build a professional network, connect with alumni, and showcase internships. Kaggle will be my space to explore data analytics, progressing from beginner notebooks to competitive participation. Together, these platforms will form a cohesive digital identity that grows alongside my academic journey.

Task 3 – Platforms Report

1. For the first task, I used HackerRank as the primary platform to practice basic programming skills. HackerRank is an online coding platform that provides beginner-friendly programming challenges and skill-based exercises in various languages such as Python, C++, and Java.

2. On this platform, I completed a beginner-level challenge called Solve Me First, where I practiced basic input-output and arithmetic operations using Python. This task helped me understand how coding problems are structured and how to write simple programs to solve them. These tools will help me academically by improving my logical thinking, programming skills, and understanding of algorithms.

Platform Used

I used Google Forms (free, integrated with my college Google account) to create the quiz. This platform was ideal because it is accessible to all batchmates, automatically collects responses, and provides instant summary charts for analysis.

What I Built

I created a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" consisting of exactly 5 questions designed to assess peers' understanding of safe and responsible digital practices:

The form includes an answer key in the description so students can self-assess after completing it.

How This Helps Academically

Google Forms will be invaluable for my academic journey. I can use it to create surveys for research projects, collect feedback from peers after presentations, and design quick assessments to gauge class understanding before exams. This tool empowers me to gather insights efficiently, whether for group projects, student council initiatives, or future research endeavours.

Task 4 – Email Etiquettes Report – Scenario

Scenario

A student group was collaborating on a major presentation using a WhatsApp group. One member sent a message: "Does anyone actually know what they're doing? This is a mess." The message was intended as frustration about the project's disorganization, but several teammates interpreted it as a personal attack on their competence. Two members disengaged from the group entirely, and the resulting conflict delayed the project by nearly a week.

What Could Have Been Done Differently

The situation could have been avoided by following simple netiquette principles. First, the frustrated member should have used clear, specific language such as: "I'm feeling overwhelmed with the current division of tasks. Can we schedule a quick call to reorganize?" Second, moving sensitive discussions to a video call or in-person meeting would have prevented tone misinterpretation. Finally, establishing communication guidelines at the start of the project including using emojis or tone indicators would have helped clarify intent and maintain a respectful environment.

Task 5 – Cyber Crime Report

What Surprised Me Most

What surprised me most while researching this topic was the alarming rise in UPI-related frauds targeting college students specifically. I learned that scammers often pose as customer service agents or class representatives, exploiting students' trust and urgency. Additionally, I was shocked to discover how many students are unaware of the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930—critical resources that enable victims to report fraud within minutes. Many students hesitate to report due to embarrassment, not realizing that swift reporting can actually freeze fraudulent transactions and recover funds.

One Habit I Will Personally Change

I will immediately change my habit of clicking on links sent via WhatsApp or SMS without verification. Previously, I assumed that messages from unknown numbers were harmless as long as I didn't share OTPs. However, I now understand that phishing links can clone UPI apps or steal credentials without requiring an OTP. Moving forward, I will always verify the sender's identity through a separate channel before clicking any link, and I will enable two-factor authentication on all financial apps.

Conclusion

1. First impressions matter recruiters check online profiles before interviews
2. Consistency across platforms builds trust and personal brand
3. Digital footprint audits should be done regularly, not just before job applications
4. Tools like GitHub and Notion reduce confusion compared to scattered WhatsApp messages
5. Clear documentation saves time and prevents miscommunication
6. Version control is essential for group projects with multiple contributors
7. Tone is easily misinterpreted in text—choose words carefully
8. Sensitive conversations belong on calls, not group chats
9. Netiquette guidelines prevent conflicts before they start
10. UPI fraud targeting students is more common than I realized
11. Reporting to 1930 within 24 hours can freeze fraudulent transactions
12. Public Wi-Fi is a major security risk for banking activities
13. A well-organized GitHub repository demonstrates professionalism
14. Documentation is as important as the work itself
15. A structured portfolio serves as both showcase and learning resource.

References

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- LinkedIn – <https://www.linkedin.com>
- Kaggle – <https://www.kaggle.com>
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